

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

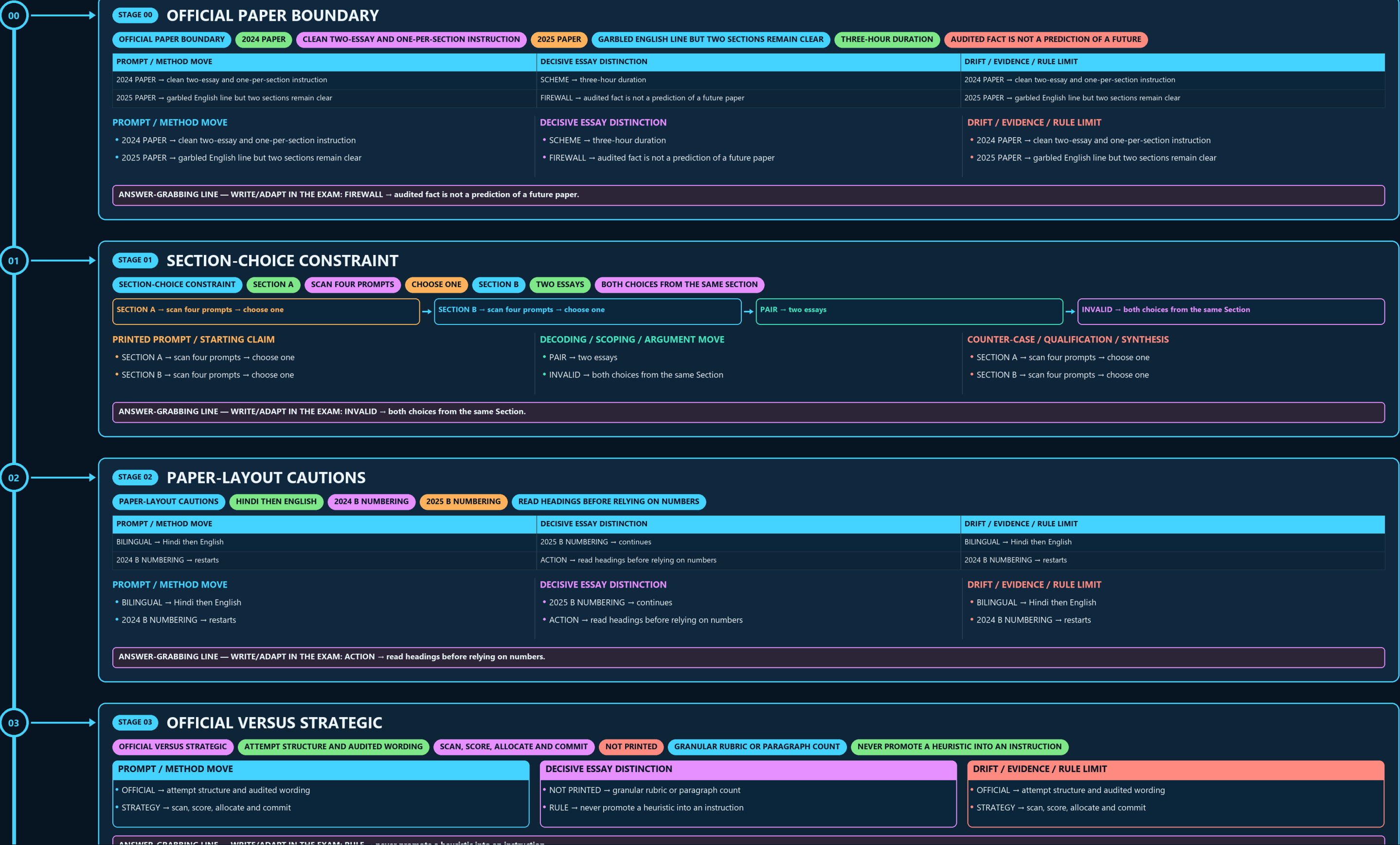
OFFICIAL PAPER BOUNDARY → SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINT → PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONS → OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC → PROMPT VIABILITY GATE → FAMILIARITY TEST

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



01

STAGE 01

SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINT

SECTION-CHOICE CONSTRAINTSECTION ASCAN FOUR PROMPTSCHOOSE ONESECTION BTWO ESSAYSBOTH CHOICES FROM THE SAME SECTION

SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one

SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one

PAIR → two essays

INVALID → both choices from the same Section

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

• SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one

• SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

• PAIR → two essays

• INVALID → both choices from the same Section

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

• SECTION A → scan four prompts → choose one

• SECTION B → scan four prompts → choose one

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INVALID → both choices from the same Section.

02

STAGE 02

PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONS

PAPER-LAYOUT CAUTIONSHINDI THEN ENGLISH2024 B NUMBERING2025 B NUMBERINGREAD HEADINGS BEFORE RELYING ON NUMBERS

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
BILINGUAL → Hindi then English	2025 B NUMBERING → continues	BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
2024 B NUMBERING → restarts	ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers	2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

• BILINGUAL → Hindi then English

• 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

• 2025 B NUMBERING → continues

• ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

• BILINGUAL → Hindi then English

• 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers.

03

STAGE 03

OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC

OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGICATTEMPT STRUCTURE AND AUDITED WORDINGSCAN, SCORE, ALLOCATE AND COMMITNOT PRINTEDGRANULAR RUBRIC OR PARAGRAPH COUNTNEVER PROMOTE A HEURISTIC INTO AN INSTRUCTION

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording	NOT PRINTED → granular rubric or paragraph count	OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording
STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit	RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction	STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

• OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording

• STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

• NOT PRINTED → granular rubric or paragraph count

• RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

• OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording

• STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction.

03

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

- BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
- 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

- 2025 B NUMBERING → continues
- ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

- BILINGUAL → Hindi then English
- 2024 B NUMBERING → restarts

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ACTION → read headings before relying on numbers.

04

STAGE 03 OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC

OFFICIAL VERSUS STRATEGIC

ATTEMPT STRUCTURE AND AUDITED WORDING

SCAN, SCORE, ALLOCATE AND COMMIT

NOT PRINTED

GRANULAR RUBRIC OR PARAGRAPH COUNT

NEVER PROMOTE A HEURISTIC INTO AN INSTRUCTION

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

- OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording
- STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

- NOT PRINTED → granular rubric or paragraph count
- RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

- OFFICIAL → attempt structure and audited wording
- STRATEGY → scan, score, allocate and commit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never promote a heuristic into an instruction.

05

STAGE 04 PROMPT VIABILITY GATE

PROMPT VIABILITY GATE

RESTATABLE CLAIM?

QUALIFIED THESIS?

DISTINCT DIMENSIONS?

SAFE EVIDENCE?

IF ANY ANSWER IS NO, RAISE RISK

RESTATABLE CLAIM?

→

QUALIFIED THESIS?

→

DISTINCT DIMENSIONS?

→

SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

- RESTATABLE CLAIM?
- QUALIFIED THESIS?

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

- DISTINCT DIMENSIONS?
- SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

- RESTATABLE CLAIM?
- QUALIFIED THESIS?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE EVIDENCE? → if any answer is no, raise risk.

06

STAGE 05 FAMILIARITY TEST

FAMILIARITY TEST

FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT

FAMILIAR + FACT STACK

UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION

POTENTIALLY SAFER

TRACTABILITY OUTRANKS COMFORT

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable	UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer	FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe	DECISION → tractability outranks comfort	FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

- FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
- FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

- UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer
- DECISION → tractability outranks comfort

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

- FAMILIAR + THESIS-FIT → usable
- FAMILIAR + FACT STACK → unsafe

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer; DECISION → tractability outranks comfort.

07

STAGE 06 ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY

ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY

PLAIN READING

FAITHFUL BUT CONTESTABLE

ORIGINAL MOVE

QUALIFIED CONNECTION OR SYNTHESIS

ECCENTRIC MOVE

LOSES THE PRINTED RELATION

ORIGINALITY THAT REMAINS TEXT-BOUND

PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable

→

ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

→

ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation

→

KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

- ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation
- KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation; KEEP → originality that remains text-bound.

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2341-5575 of 10256 • continues below

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNFAMILIAR + CLEAR TENSION → potentially safer; DECISION → tractability outranks comfort.

06

STAGE 06 ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY

ORIGINALITY BOUNDARY PLAIN READING FAITHFUL BUT CONTESTABLE ORIGINAL MOVE QUALIFIED CONNECTION OR SYNTHESIS ECCENTRIC MOVE LOSES THE PRINTED RELATION ORIGINALITY THAT REMAINS TEXT-BOUND

PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable

ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation

KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

- ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation
- KEEP → originality that remains text-bound

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

- PLAIN READING → faithful but contestable
- ORIGINAL MOVE → qualified connection or synthesis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ECCENTRIC MOVE → loses the printed relation; KEEP → originality that remains text-bound.

07

STAGE 07 EVIDENCE-RISK SCREEN

EVIDENCE-RISK SCREEN NAMED AND SAFELY RECALLABLE ILLUSTRATION USEFUL BUT DETAIL UNCERTAIN INVENTED NUMBER, AUTHOR OR FORCED EXAMPLE PREFER THE PROMPT WITH STRONGER EVIDENCE SAFETY

GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration

AMBER → useful but detail uncertain

RED → invented number, author or forced example

CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

- GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration
- AMBER → useful but detail uncertain

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

- RED → invented number, author or forced example
- CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

- GREEN → named and safely recallable illustration
- AMBER → useful but detail uncertain

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHOICE → prefer the prompt with stronger evidence safety.

08

STAGE 08 CONCLUSION FEASIBILITY

CONCLUSION FEASIBILITY EARNED SYNTHESIS FORCED ENDING WARNING THAT CHOICE MAY BE WEAK

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

- THESIS → DIMENSIONS → COUNTER-VIEW
- COUNTER-VIEW → QUALIFICATION

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

- QUALIFICATION → EARNED SYNTHESIS
- FORCED ENDING → warning that choice may be weak

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

- THESIS → DIMENSIONS → COUNTER-VIEW
- COUNTER-VIEW → QUALIFICATION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FORCED ENDING → warning that choice may be weak.

09

STAGE 09 TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO

TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO ESSAY A CLARITY + DEPTH + EVIDENCE ESSAY B SHARED BUDGET PLANNING + DRAFTING + REVISION PAIR TEST NEITHER CHOICE SHOULD IMPOVERISH THE OTHER

ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence

ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision

PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision
- PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other.

09

STAGE 09 TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO

TWO-ESSAY PORTFOLIO ESSAY A CLARITY + DEPTH + EVIDENCE ESSAY B SHARED BUDGET PLANNING + DRAFTING + REVISION PAIR TEST NEITHER CHOICE SHOULD IMPOVERISH THE OTHER

ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence

ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision

PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- SHARED BUDGET → planning + drafting + revision
- PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- ESSAY A → clarity + depth + evidence
- ESSAY B → clarity + depth + evidence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PAIR TEST → neither choice should impoverish the other.

10

STAGE 10 COMMITMENT RULE

COMMITMENT RULE BOUNDED SCAN VIABILITY PASSED EARLY FAILURE SWITCH ONCE BEFORE DRAFTING EXPANDS LATE DOUBT RETURN TO THESIS AND EVIDENCE MAP DO NOT CHASE A FASHIONABLE ALTERNATIVE

BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit

EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands

LATE DOUBT → return to thesis and evidence map

DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit
- EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- LATE DOUBT → return to thesis and evidence map
- DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- BOUNDED SCAN → viability passed → commit
- EARLY FAILURE → switch once before drafting expands

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → do not chase a fashionable alternative.

11

STAGE 11 SELECTION ANSWER SPINE

SELECTION ANSWER SPINE READ RULE SCAN EACH SECTION CLASSIFY PROMPTS TEST THESIS TEST DIMENSIONS TEST EVIDENCE SCREEN RISK

READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS

TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE

SCREEN RISK → TEST THE PAIR → ALLOCATE TIME

COMMIT → DECODE OR SCOPE → PLAN

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS
- TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- SCREEN RISK → TEST THE PAIR → ALLOCATE TIME
- COMMIT → DECODE OR SCOPE → PLAN

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS
- TEST THESIS → TEST DIMENSIONS → TEST EVIDENCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READ RULE → SCAN EACH SECTION → CLASSIFY PROMPTS.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT APHORISM PROMPTS (MOST OF BOTH YEARS' SECTIONS) ISSUE-STATEMENT PROMPTS (E.G. 2024-B5 ON SOCIAL MEDIA/FOMO) HIGH-FIT PROMPT THESIS EMERGES WITHIN ABOUT A MINUTE, ≥2 REAL LOW-FIT PROMPT ANY OF THE ABOVE MISSING, OR ONLY RECOVERABLE

INTEREST VS. TRACTABILITY

OPTIONAL INTERPRETIVE / DIALECTICAL DEPTH

- Aphorism prompts (most of both years' Sections): compressed,
- Issue-statement prompts (e.g. 2024-B5 on social media/FOMO): more
- High-fit prompt: thesis emerges within about a minute, ≥2 real
- Low-fit prompt: any of the above missing, or only recoverable

PROMPT, ATTRIBUTION OR OFFICIAL-RULE LIMIT

- Interest vs. tractability: the assumption that liking a subject
- Familiarity vs. depth: a "familiar" topic invites GS-answer
- Speed vs. reversibility: choice happens early and is costly to
- NOT: Sunk-cost persistence: continuing with a poorly-fitting prompt

COMPARATIVE ARGUMENT / STRUCTURE NUANCE

- NOT: Over-deliberation: spending disproportionate time optimising
- NOT: Choosing purely to avoid a weaker Section, ignoring that both
- Subject: Essay | Tier: Advanced | GS Paper: Essay (General Studies Paper — Essay, Mains).
- Core area: Choice as a portfolio/risk decision

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.